

User Manual

Library Management System

Uttar Pradesh State Tax Training & Research Institute (UPSTTRI)

Application Version 1.1.2

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User Manual

A step-by-step guide for librarians and administrators to operate the UPSTTRI Library Management System.

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1. About This Manual

This manual explains how to use the UPSTTRI Library Management System — a desktop application for managing books, members, and the daily issue/return operations of the library. It is written for the **administrator/librarian**, who is the only role that signs in to the system.

Each section walks through a task with numbered steps. Look out for the coloured boxes:

Tip — a helpful shortcut or best practice.

Caution — an action that cannot easily be undone.

2. Getting Started

2.1 System Requirements

Item	Requirement
Operating System	Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit)
Database	MySQL 8.0+ (installed and running)
Disk Space	~300 MB for the application plus space for the database and uploads
Display	1366×768 or higher recommended

2.2 Installing the Application

1. Run the provided installer (created with Inno Setup) and follow the on-screen prompts.
2. Ensure MySQL is running and the `library_management` database has been created and loaded from `schema_v2.sql` (your IT team usually does this once).
3. Launch the application from the Start Menu or desktop shortcut. The bundled backend service starts automatically.

2.3 Logging In

1. On the login screen, enter your **username** and **password**.
2. Click **Login**.

3. On first login you are required to change the default password. Choose a strong new password and confirm it.

Role	Default Username	Default Password
Admin	admin	Library#123

Only admin accounts can sign in. After too many failed attempts (15 within 15 minutes) login is temporarily blocked to protect against brute-force attacks. Wait a few minutes and try again.

Change the default password immediately and store the new one securely. Sessions expire automatically; if you are logged out, simply sign in again.

3. Understanding the Interface

After login the main window appears with two areas:

- **Sidebar (left):** primary navigation, quick actions, theme toggle, and logout.
- **Content area (right):** shows the screen for the selected menu item.

3.1 Sidebar Navigation

Menu Item	What it opens
Dashboard	Overview with KPIs, charts, alerts, and recent activity.
Books	The book catalogue with add/edit/delete and import/export.
Members	The member directory with profiles and history.
Issues & Returns	Issue books, process returns, and handle overdue items.
Reports	Analytical reports with PDF/Excel export.
About Us	Application and institute information, version details.

3.2 Quick Actions & Top Bar

- **Advanced Search** — open a multi-field search dialog from the sidebar quick actions.
- **Backup & Restore** — open data backup tools from the sidebar quick actions.
- **Notification bell** — shows unread alerts with a count badge.
- **Theme toggle** — switch between light and dark mode.
- **Logout** — sign out securely.

4. The Dashboard

The Dashboard is the home screen and updates in real time.

4.1 What You See

- **KPI cards:** total books, issued, available, overdue, and active members.
- **Library Statistics chart:** a bar chart of books by category.
- **Book Status Distribution:** a pie chart of available vs issued copies.
- **Actionable Alerts:** colour-coded sections for overdue, due-today, and low-stock items, each with a **View All** option.
- **Recent Activity:** a live feed that refreshes automatically every few seconds.

Use the alerts panel each morning to quickly spot overdue loans and books due back that day.

5. Managing Books

Open **Books** from the sidebar to view the catalogue. Each book shows its title, author, category, availability, and cover image.

5.1 Adding a Book

1. Click **Add Book**.
2. Fill in the details: title and author (required), plus ISBN, category, rack number, publisher, year, and description.
3. Set **Total Copies**. The available count is tracked automatically as books are issued and returned.
4. Optionally upload a **cover image** and preview it.
5. Click **Save**.

5.2 Editing or Deleting a Book

- **Edit**: click the edit icon on a book row, change the fields, and save.
- **Delete**: click the delete icon and confirm. Use **bulk delete** to remove several selected books at once.

Deleting a book also removes its issue records. Make sure no copies are currently on loan before deleting.

5.3 Categories

Manage genres/categories from the books area. You can create, rename, and delete categories used when classifying books.

5.4 Importing Books in Bulk

1. Click **Import** and choose a `.csv` or `.xlsx` file.
2. The system maps common column headers automatically (title, author, ISBN, category, etc.).
3. Review and confirm the import.

Search and filter the catalogue by title, author, category, year, or availability to quickly find a book.

5.5 Exporting Books

Export the catalogue to **CSV** or **JSON** for backup or external reporting using the export option in the books toolbar.

6. Managing Members

Open **Members** to view the member directory. Members are grouped by type, each with its own borrowing limits.

6.1 Member Types & Limits

Type	Max Books	Loan Period
Student / Guest	3	14 days
Staff	5	21 days
Faculty	10	30 days

6.2 Adding a Member

1. Click **Add Member**.
2. Enter name (required), email, phone, address, and member type.
3. Set the membership date and optional expiry date.
4. Optionally upload a **profile photo**.
5. Click **Save**.

6.3 Editing, Activating & Deactivating

- **Edit**: click the edit icon, update details, and save.
- **Activate / Deactivate**: toggle a member's status. Deactivated members cannot borrow new books.
- **Bulk delete** and **CSV/JSON export** are available from the toolbar.

6.4 Viewing Borrowing History

Open a member to see their current loans and full borrowing history, including statistics dialogs that summarise their activity.

7. Issuing & Returning Books

Open **Issues & Returns** to manage circulation.

7.1 Issuing a Book

1. Click **Issue Book**.

2. Select the **member** and the **book** (only available copies can be issued).

3. The **due date** is calculated automatically from the member's type.

4. Confirm to issue. The available copy count decreases automatically.

You can print a borrow slip for the member after issuing.

7.2 Returning a Book

1. Find the active issue in the list (filter by member or overdue status if needed).

2. Click **Return**.

3. If the book is overdue, a **fine** is calculated and shown.

4. Confirm. The copy becomes available again immediately.

7.3 Overdue & Reminders

- Overdue and due-soon items appear on the dashboard and in this screen.
- Use **Send Reminder** to record a reminder, or **Mark Returned** to process a return directly.
- You can edit an issue to extend the due date or change its status.

8. Reports & Analytics

Open **Reports** to generate insights about library usage. Each report can be exported to **PDF** or **Excel**.

Report	Shows
Library Statistics	Books grouped by category (bar chart).
Book Status Distribution	Available vs issued copies (pie chart).
Popular Books	Books ranked by number of times borrowed.
Active Members	Most active members with statistics.
Overdue Report	Full list of currently overdue loans.
Monthly Statistics	Circulation trends over time.

Reports support Hindi/Devanagari text, so member and book names in Hindi render correctly in exported PDFs.

9. Notifications

The notification bell in the top bar shows an unread count.

- Click the bell to view notifications: overdue, due-soon, new-book, system, and status messages.
- Mark notifications as read individually or all at once.
- Delete notifications you no longer need.
- Notifications refresh automatically and update instantly after you change data.

10. Search & Recommendations

10.1 Global & Advanced Search

- Use the **Advanced Search** quick action to search across books, members, and issues with multiple filters.
- Results open in a dialog where you can jump directly to a record.

10.2 Recommendations

Open a member to view book recommendations generated from their borrowing history — useful for suggesting titles at the desk.

11. Backup, Restore & Data Export

Open **Backup & Restore** from the sidebar quick actions.

11.1 Creating a Backup

1. Click **Backup** to download a single JSON file containing books, members, and issues.
2. Store the file in a safe location (external drive or network share).

Perform regular backups — at minimum weekly, and always before a large import or before deleting records.

11.2 Restoring from Backup

1. Click **Restore** and select a previously created JSON backup file.
2. Confirm to restore the data.

Restoring replaces existing data with the backup contents. Only restore from a trusted, verified backup file.

11.3 Exporting Data

Books, members, and issues can each be exported to CSV or JSON from their respective screens for use in spreadsheets or other systems.

12. Settings & Themes

- **Theme:** use the toggle in the sidebar to switch between light and dark mode. The choice is remembered.
- **Dashboard widgets:** widget visibility and layout are saved per user.
- **Password:** you are prompted to change the default password on first login; keep it secure.

13. Troubleshooting & FAQ

Problem	Solution
Cannot log in	Check username/password. After 15 failed tries, wait 15 minutes. Confirm the backend and MySQL are running.

App shows no data / connection error	Ensure MySQL is running and the database is loaded. Restart the application so the bundled backend relaunches.
Session expired message	This is normal after inactivity. Simply log in again.
Cannot issue a book	The book may have no available copies, or the member is inactive or at their borrowing limit.
Import didn't map columns	Check your CSV/XLSX headers (title, author, ISBN, category) and re-import.
Hindi text looks wrong in PDF	The app bundles a Devanagari font; ensure you are using the built-in export rather than copying text externally.

14. Keyboard & Quick Tips

- Check the **Dashboard alerts** daily for overdue and due-today items.
- Use **Advanced Search** to locate records fast instead of scrolling.
- Run a **Backup** before bulk imports or bulk deletes.
- Keep member types accurate — they control borrowing limits and loan periods automatically.
- Export reports to **PDF** for printing and **Excel** for further analysis.